

Li Zhang

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EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Doctor of Philosophy in Intelligent Systems

Pittsburgh, U.S.A.

Aug. 2024 - Apr. 2029

- Research: AI & Law
- Advisor: Prof. [Kevin Ashley](#)
- GPA: 4.0/4.0
- Courses: Large Language Models, Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning

Tsinghua University

Master of Computational Law

Beijing, China

Sep. 2019 - Jun. 2022

- Research: Computational Law

Australian National University

Study Abroad in College of Engineering and Computer Science

Canberra, Australia

Jul. 2017 - Dec. 2017

- GPA: 6.5/7.0

China University of Mining and Technology

Bachelor of Electrical Engineering

Jiangsu, China

Sep. 2015 - Jun. 2019

- GPA: 90.91/100, Ranking: 2/278

PROJECTS

LLM Alignment in Trustworthy Legal Reasoning

Pittsburgh, U.S.A

Li Zhang, Matthias Grabmair, Morgan Gray, Kevin Ashley

Aug. 2024 -

- Proposed a formal framework that decomposes the process of identifying significant distinctions between cases into three-stage reasoning tasks. Revealed the paradox that LLMs expend more computational resources on incorrect responses than correct ones, suggesting that “thinking longer” does not always mean “thinking smarter.”
- Created a multi-agent framework to generate reliable legal arguments through collaboration and reflection mechanisms, achieving a decent performance in hallucination accuracy and abstention rate.

ML-Based Prediction of Academic Performance

Pittsburgh, U.S.A

Li Zhang, Morgan Gray, Jessica Macaluso, Kevin Ashley, Scott Fraundorf

Aug. 2024 -

- Developed a machine learning model that achieved a high accuracy for law school academic performance using feature engineering and random forest regression, enabling identification of at-risk students for early interventions.
- Conducted comprehensive feature selection and statistical analysis that revealed skill-specific predictors of academic success, providing actionable insights for legal education pedagogy and personalized learning approaches.

Automated Legal Citation Correction through ML and NLP

Beijing, China

Li Zhang

Jun. 2021 - June. 2022

- Built a DynamoDB repository for structured storage of labeled citation errors, enabling iterative model refinement. Achieved 95% precision in detecting inconsistencies through feature engineering.
- Designed and deployed a scalable citation-correction system to train and host the NLP model. Partnered with legal researchers to validate outputs against the Bluebook standard.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

1. Thinking Longer, Not Always Smarter: Evaluating LLM Capabilities in Hierarchical Legal Reasoning[[Link](#)]

Li Zhang, Matthias Grabmair, Morgan Gray, Kevin Ashley
CS&Law 2026

2. DenseMixer: Improving MoE Post-Training with Precise Router Gradient[[Link](#)]

Feng Yao, Junxia Cui, Ruohan Zhang, Liyuan Liu, Shibo Hao, **Li Zhang**, Chengyu Dong, Shuohang Wang, Yelong Shen, Jianfeng Gao, Jingbo Shang
ICLR 2026, under review

3. Do LLMs Truly Understand When a Precedent Is Overruled?[[Link](#)]

Li Zhang, Jaromir Savelka, Kevin Ashley
JURIX 2025, Best Student Paper

4. Mitigating Manipulation and Enhancing Persuasion: A Reflective Multi-Agent Approach for Legal Argument Generation[Link]
Li Zhang, Kevin Ashley
LCIC @ ICAIL 2025
5. Measuring Faithfulness and Abstention: An Automated Pipeline for Evaluating LLM-Generated 3-ply Case-Based Legal Arguments[Link]
Li Zhang, Morgan Gray, Jaromir Savelka, Kevin Ashley
ASAIL @ ICAIL 2025
6. Generating Case-Based Legal Arguments with LLMs[Link]
Morgan Gray, **Li Zhang**, Kevin Ashley
CS&Law 2025
7. Intelligent Proximate Analysis of Coal Based on Near-Infrared Spectroscopy[Link]
Weinan Liu, Boyuan Peng, Xiaoyu Liu, Feifan Ren, **Li Zhang***
Journal of Applied Spectroscopy, 2021

TALKS

1. Do LLMs Truly Understand When a Precedent Is Overruled, [2025 Pittsburgh Legal AI Summit](#), Carnegie Mellon University
2. Mitigating Manipulation and Enhancing Persuasion: A Reflective Multi-Agent Approach for Legal Argument Generation, [ResearchTrend.AI](#)
3. Enhancing Legal Argument Generation: From Basic Schemes to Trustworthy Multi-Agent Systems, [ISP Forum](#), University of Pittsburgh

LEGAL EXPERIENCE

The Export-Import Bank of China, Nanjing, China

Legal Counselor, Jun. 2022 - Jun. 2024

Spearheaded legal negotiations for complex banking transactions, ensuring strict adherence to regulatory compliance and risk mitigation strategies. Drafted and reviewed extensive credit facility agreements and security documents to safeguard the bank's interests in cross-border financing. Collaborated with internal stakeholders to provide strategic legal counsel on operational risks and dispute resolution matters.

SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

- **Programming:** Python (PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Pandas and NumPy), SQL, JavaScript
- **Cloud Technologies:** SageMaker, DynamoDB and API Gateway
- **Legal:** PRC Legal Professional Qualification
- **Others:** L^AT_EX, Markdown, Linux, Shell and Anaconda

SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

- SCI Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh, 2024
- Dean's List (top 1%), Tsinghua Law School, 2022
- Law School Fellowship, Tsinghua Law School, 2021
- Dean's List (top 1%), China University of Mining and Technology, 2019